

SESSION 4

PRACTICES — Working with AI well

3:00–4:00 PM • 60
minutes

From “using AI” to “working with AI”

Session 3 gave us the possibilities. Session 4 gives us the habits.

- A good result starts before the prompt
- Context improves usefulness
- Iteration improves fit
- Verification protects quality
- Human judgment owns the final decision

The core practice loop

A simple cycle for almost any AI task

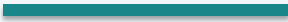
1. Frame — define the goal and constraints
2. Contextualize — give AI the information it needs
3. Generate — ask for a useful first output
4. Inspect — challenge assumptions and errors
5. Refine — iterate toward the actual need
6. Decide — the human owns the final use

The loop

**FRAME → CONTEXT
→ GENERATE →
INSPECT
→ REFINE → DECIDE**

1 — Better inputs

Good prompts are usually good briefs.



Transition: “Prompting starts with thinking. Before asking AI for output, make the task legible.”

2 min

The anatomy of a useful request

You rarely need all six, but know what each adds

Goal — what are we trying to achieve?

Context — what should AI know?

Audience — who is this for?

Constraints — what must / must not happen?

Output — what should the response look like?

Evaluation — what makes the result good?

Activity — Upgrade the prompt

7 minutes pairs

DO

Start with: “Make a presentation about AI.”

Add a specific goal and audience.

Add context and constraints.

Specify the output format.

Add one quality criterion.

Compare the original and upgraded requests.

DEBRIEF

Which added detail made the biggest difference?

What information did you still need?

Did the prompt become clearer—or merely longer?

Give AI something to work with

Context is often the missing ingredient

Paste or attach the relevant source material when appropriate

State what the information means and what it does not mean

Separate facts from assumptions

Tell AI what previous attempts did not work

Use examples when the desired output is hard to describe

2 — Iteration & dialogue

The first answer is a draft, not a verdict.



Transition: “Now that the task is well framed, the next practice is to work in rounds.”

2 min

Use conversation strategically

Ask for moves, not miracles

Start broad when exploring; become specific when deciding

Ask AI to show assumptions and identify missing information

Request alternatives rather than accepting the first idea

Critique the output against explicit criteria

Change one important variable at a time

Think in rounds

DRAFT
→ **CRITIQUE**
→ **REVISE**
→ **CHECK**

Verification: trust, but verify

Verification should match the consequences

Check important facts against reliable sources

Recalculate important numbers independently

Open and inspect cited material

Test code or formulas before relying on them

Ask: “What would make this answer wrong?”

Escalate high-stakes decisions to qualified humans

Practice — Build a verification step

Every useful workflow needs a quality gate

For your use case, identify the most likely failure.

Choose an independent check.

Define who performs the check.

Decide what happens if the check fails.

Write the checkpoint into the workflow—not as an afterthought.

3 — Responsible practice

Good AI work includes boundaries.



Transition: “Quality is not only about whether the output sounds good. It is also about whether the workflow is appropriate.”

2 min

Four boundaries to check

Before putting AI into a real workflow

Privacy — am I sharing information I am allowed to share?

Security — could the input or output create a security problem?

Rights — do I have the right to use this material and output?

Impact — who could be harmed, excluded, misled, or disadvantaged?

Human-in-the-loop is a design choice

Decide where humans must remain responsible

Human sets the objective and constraints

AI performs useful transformation or generation

Human checks quality and context

Human makes consequential decisions

The workflow records or communicates uncertainty when needed

Final activity — Design your AI practice

8 minutes individual; 2 minutes share

DO

Choose the use case you want to test.

Write your task brief: goal, context, audience, constraints, output.

Define your first prompt or instruction.

Add a critique/refinement step.

Add a verification checkpoint.

Write one boundary or “do not use AI for...” rule.

DEBRIEF

What will you try first?

What will you check?

Where does human judgment stay?

What result would tell you to stop or redesign the workflow?

Your AI practice checklist

A compact habit to take away

- ☐ Is the goal clear?
- ☐ Did I provide relevant context?
- ☐ Did I specify the audience and output?
- ☐ Did I iterate instead of accepting the first answer?
- ☐ Did I verify what matters?
- ☐ Did I protect sensitive information and rights?
- ☐ Is a human accountable for the decision?

Remember

**FRAME WELL.
ITERATE.
VERIFY.
OWN THE DECISION.**

Closing — AI is a practice, not a button

The durable skill is knowing how to work with capability

Use AI where it creates meaningful value

Design the workflow—not just the prompt

Keep skepticism proportional to the stakes

Protect people, information, and accountability

Learn from each experiment and improve the process